



Java Map

[< Previous](#)[Next >](#)

Java Map Interface

The **Map** interface is a part of the Java Collections Framework and is used to store **key-value pairs**. Each key must be unique, but values can be duplicated.

A **Map** is useful when you want to associate a key (like a name or ID) with a value (like an age or description).

Common classes that implement **Map** :

- HashMap - fast and unordered
- TreeMap - sorted by key
- LinkedHashMap - ordered by insertion

Tip: Use a **Map** when you want to associate values with unique keys, like storing user IDs with names.

Common Map Methods

Method	Description
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`remove()` Removes the key and its value

`containsKey()` Checks if the map contains the key

`keySet()` Returns a set of all keys

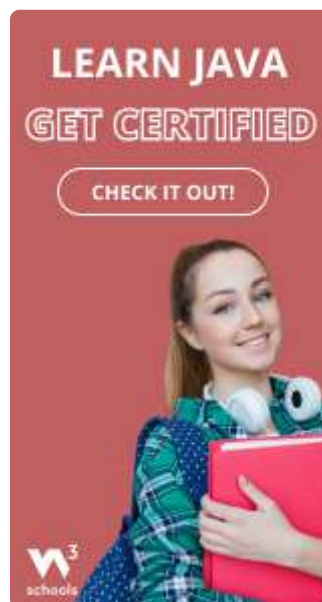
Map vs. Set vs. List

Feature	List	Set	Map
Duplicates allowed?	Yes	No	Keys: No Values: Yes
Stores key-value pairs?	No	No	Yes
Maintains order?	Yes	No (unless using TreeSet or LinkedHashSet)	No (unless using TreeMap or LinkedHashMap)

Next, we'll look at how to use `HashMap` to store items in key/value pairs.

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